

However, if you want a phone call and they will only text, that's not going to be a good fit.

### **Is this your full-time job?**

Many agents are part-timers—at least until they start to generate enough income to make it a full-time job. That doesn't mean they're any worse than a full-time agent, but it does mean they might not be available when you need them to be.

Some part-time agents have a highly flexible schedule at their day job, so this isn't a deal breaker. Other part-time agents will only be available nights and weekends, which is obviously not ideal. Just make sure you know what you need, then find an agent who meets those needs.

### **Have you ever had to use your E&O insurance? Have you ever been subject to a disciplinary action by the Division of Real Estate?**

Pay close attention to the answers. E&O stands for "errors and omissions," and it is a required type of coverage for any mistakes the agent might make on a transaction. Though one mistake doesn't define an agent, you should be wary about moving forward with someone who has needed to file a claim or has been subject to disciplinary action. You want to work with an agent who knows what they're doing and does it right, every single time.

### **How many houses will you show me?**

We have encountered many people who say their agent announced they would show only X number of houses to them. This is patently absurd, and you shouldn't enter into a relationship with an agent who does not respond with some version of "as many as it takes for you to find the right home."

### **What are your fees?**

Real estate agents are usually paid a success fee by the seller at closing, so their payment is not your problem. However, some agents prefer to get paid earlier or charge retainers or hourly rates. If you're unwilling to pay for the cost of the agent, it's best to know about any fees they will charge you up front.

### **Will I be working with you or with a member of your team?**